



### Up in the air

Walking on stilts makes your legs longer. Now you can splash through puddles and your clothes still won't get wet. A little wading bird, called the black-winged stilt, likes to keep its feathers dry, so it has very, very long legs, which work like stilts.

### Fitting the bill

Storks stab, shoebills dig, flamingos sieve, and spoonbills trap—these amazing beaks, or bills, are all shaped to catch food.



Spoonbill



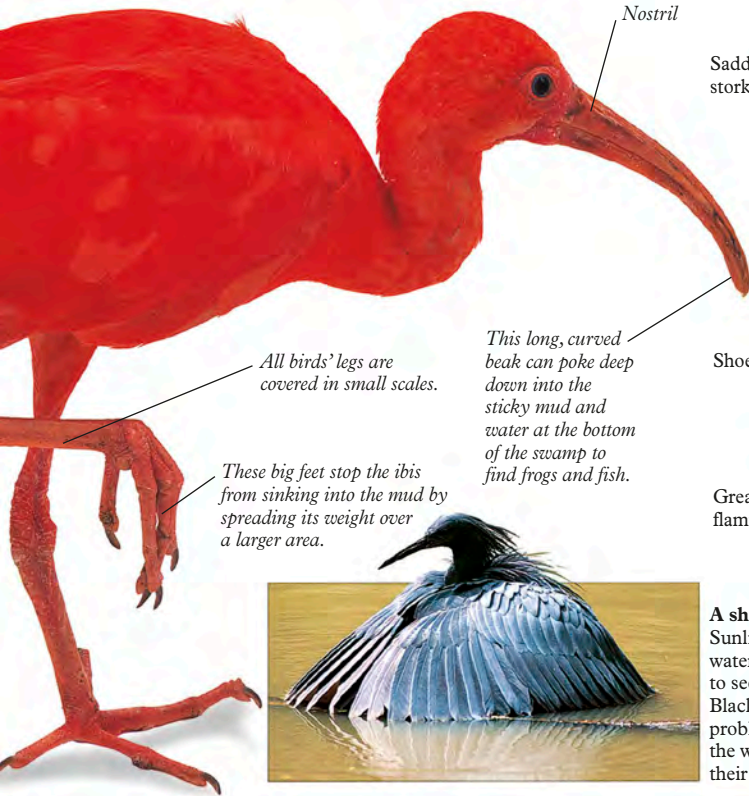
Saddle-billed stork



Shoebill



Greater flamingo



Nostril

*All birds' legs are covered in small scales.*

*These big feet stop the ibis from sinking into the mud by spreading its weight over a larger area.*

*This long, curved beak can poke deep down into the sticky mud and water at the bottom of the swamp to find frogs and fish.*



### A shady bird

Sunlight shining on water makes it hard to see the fish below. Black herons solve this problem by shading the water with their wings.

